

As I went down to the river to pray

Text: African American Spiritual

Music: African American Spiritual

AS I WENT DOWN TO THE RIVER TO PRAY irregular

The musical score is written on four staves in G-flat major (three flats) and 2/2 time. The melody is characterized by a mix of 2/2 and 3/2 measures, creating an irregular feel. Chord symbols (G-flat, D-flat, C-flat) are placed above the staff to indicate harmonic support. The lyrics are written below the notes, with some words hyphenated across measures. The score concludes with a double bar line and the word 'Fine'.

As I went down to the riv-er to pray, stud-y-in' a-bout that good old way,
and who shall wear the star - ry crown, good Lord, show me the way.
1 Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, let's go down, come on down.
Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, down to the riv-er to pray.

2. Oh, brothers, ...

3. Oh, children, ...

4. Oh, sinners, ...